FaujPrep

ISSB Preparation 3: Interview, Leadership, and Adaptability

Leadership is behaviour

Leadership is not simply giving orders or speaking confidently. In a team, it can mean clarifying the objective, noticing a practical risk, helping members coordinate, taking responsibility for your own part, or changing direction when evidence changes. Choose examples from your own life; do not borrow a dramatic story.

Prepare a small example bank

Write five short examples:

1. A time you worked with people who disagreed.
2. A task you completed without close supervision.
3. A setback and the specific change you made afterward.
4. A time you supported a teammate.
5. A decision where you weighed risk and responsibility.

For each, describe the situation, your own action, the result, and one lesson. Keep each example to about a minute. Be ready for follow-ups about your role, what others did, and what you would change.

Example: prepare for the counter-question chain

Question: "Tell me about a time you took responsibility."

Example answer: "During a class project, our group was missing a section two days before the deadline. I asked what was unfinished, divided the remaining research into two small tasks, and volunteered to combine the final slides. We submitted on time. I should have checked progress earlier instead of waiting until the deadline was close."

Now practise the likely probes:

- "Did you do all the work yourself?" "No. Each member completed a section; I coordinated the remaining tasks and assembled the slides."
- "Why did the work fall behind?" State the real reason, including your own part if relevant.
- "What if a member still did not deliver?" Explain how you would check in, reassign only what is reasonable, and inform the teacher or responsible person if needed.
- "What does this prove about your leadership?" Do not say it proves you are always a leader. Explain the specific behaviour it shows and what you learned.

The strongest preparation is to know the facts behind your example so that follow-ups do not force you to improvise or exaggerate.

Answer the question, then explain

Use a direct first sentence. Add one relevant example or reason. Stop when you have answered. If the question is unclear, ask for clarification. If you do not know, say so and distinguish what you know from what you are uncertain about.

In team exercises

Focus on the objective and constraints. Offer a workable idea, listen to the group's feedback, and help adapt the plan. If selected to coordinate, keep the group moving and include useful contributions. If someone else is leading, contribute and support the shared objective rather than competing for control.

After a difficult moment

Do not assume that one mistake has ruined an assessment. Recover, listen to the next instruction, and engage constructively. Avoid blaming another candidate or repeatedly explaining yourself when the task has moved on. Adaptability is shown by what you do next.

Practice with honest feedback

Ask a teacher or family member to observe a practice discussion. Have them note specific behaviours: Did you listen? Did you speak clearly? Did you help the group decide? Did you stay useful when your suggestion was not chosen? Select one concrete improvement for the next practice.

Distinguish your own evidence

Initial-interview practice is useful for explaining your background and motivation. ISSB preparation should also help you reflect across examples and respond to unfamiliar situations. Do not assume that one polished "Why Army?" answer will cover every conversation; understand your own reasons well enough to answer a different follow-up honestly.

What not to do

Do not imitate a "leader personality," dominate peers, manufacture achievements, or use rehearsed answers that do not match your application. Avoid treating every interaction as a test to manipulate.

Reminder

ISSB guidance and assessment procedures are controlled by the official board. Preparation can improve communication and self-awareness, but cannot ensure a recommendation or commission.

Research basis

The ISSB candidate guidelines (https://issb.gov.pk/guidelines) identify teamwork, willingness to participate, clear thinking, and staying calm under stress as desirable qualities. The ISSB selection-system page (https://issb.gov.pk/selection-system) is the official source for current process information; this note is not a task-by-task assessment rubric.